

The A13 OLinuXino features a 1 GHz Allwinner A13 ARM Cortex-A13 processor and Mali 400 graphics. And the iMX233-OLinuXino-MAXI has a 454 MHz Freescale i.MX233 processor. The latter has been specifically designed for embedded computing applications, while the A13 model can be used as the basis for an Android or Linux computer.

Android users: Beware of SMiShing!

It seems that hackers are leaving no stone unturned in attacking Android devices. Recently, security researcher, Xuxian Jiang and his team at North Carolina State University uncovered a new vulnerability in the Android 4.0.4 (ICS) OS—a new kind of phishing named ‘SMiShing’. This vulnerability is also present on the latest Jelly Bean flavour of Android. Researcher Jiang has previously discovered several other Android vulnerabilities and he has posted a YouTube video demonstrating the new phishing style.

“While continuing our efforts on various smartphone-related research projects, we came across a smishing (SMS-Phishing) vulnerability in popular Android platforms. This vulnerability allows a running app on an Android phone to fake arbitrary SMS text messages, which will then be received by phone users. We believe such a vulnerability can be readily exploited to launch various phishing attacks,” wrote Jiang in an official blog posting.

According to Jiang, one serious aspect of the vulnerability is that it does not require (the exploiting) app to request any permission to launch the attack. (In other words, this can be characterised as a WRITE_SMS capability leak.) Another serious aspect is that the vulnerability appears to be present in multiple Android platforms. To quote Jiang, “... in fact, because the vulnerability is contained in the Android Open Source Project (or AOSP), we suspect it exists in all recent Android platforms, though we have so far only confirmed its presence in a number of phones, including Google Galaxy Nexus, Google Nexus S, Samsung Galaxy SIII, HTC One X, HTC Inspire, and Xiaomi MI-One. The affected platforms that have been confirmed range from Froyo (2.2.x), Gingerbread (2.3.x), Ice Cream Sandwich (4.0.x) and Jelly Bean (4.1).”

Google releases Chrome 23

If you love using the much admired Google Chrome, here is an update that will interest you. Google has released the latest version of the Chrome Web browser for Windows, Mac and Linux—23.0.1271.64.

If you already use Chrome, this update will reach you automatically. But those who want to give Chrome a try for the first time can get hold of the latest release by visiting google.com/chrome.

So if you're wondering what's new with Chrome 23, according to Google notes, this release comes with a slew of new features that “...include GPU accelerated video decoding on Windows and easier website permissions.”

This basically indicates that you can expect a better battery life. The search giant also said that, “...dedicated graphics chips draw far less power than a computer's CPU, so using GPU-accelerated video decoding while watching videos can increase battery life significantly.”

Besides, it would get “...easier to view and control any website's permissions for capabilities such as geolocation, pop-ups, and camera or microphone access.” Users can also send a ‘Do Not Track’ request to websites.



SUSE Linux Enterprise high availability extension gets SAP NetWeaver integration

SUSE recently announced that its SUSE Linux Enterprise High Availability Extension 11 Service Pack 2 is certified for integration with the SAP NetWeaver technology platform. The SAP certification scenario, which is called ‘SAP NetWeaver High Availability Cluster (NW-HA-CLU) 730’ establishes a reference architecture to help ensure compliant implementation of high-availability scenarios for running SAP solutions.



The SAP Integration and Certification Center (SAP ICC) has certified SUSE Linux Enterprise High Availability Extension 11 SP2 via the NW-HA-CLU 730 integration scenario for the Linux x86_64 platform. SUSE Linux Enterprise High Availability Extension is included with SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 11 SP2 for SAP Applications. The high-availability extension helps customers reduce unplanned downtime and further ensures continuous access to mission-critical applications and data.

This reference combination offers customers improved speed, reliability and flexibility. First, it helps customers reduce time to revenue by accelerating integration projects and easing implementation. Second, the technical alignment of SUSE with SAP solutions through certification also improves reliability and supportability. Finally, improved integration of SUSE Linux Enterprise High Availability Extension with the control framework of SAP solutions gives customers the flexibility to add new functionality.